

THE MEMERY FIELD GUIDE / 2027

The AI Visibility Playbook

How to make your brand findable, credible and recommendable in generative search.

WHAT WE KNOW / WHAT APPEARS TO WORK / WHAT WE STILL NEED TO TEST

A practical guide, scorecard and 90-day plan for marketing leaders.



THE CHANGE

From search result to AI answer

AI systems now help people compare options and form opinions in a conversation. Your brand can shape that answer even when a visit to your site never happens.

THE OLD JOURNEY

Search results

Question → results → website → decision

THE NEW JOURNEY

Generated answers

Question → synthesis → follow-up → shortlist

THE WORKING DEFINITION

What GEO means

Generative Engine Optimisation (GEO) is the practice of improving the chance that AI systems can find, understand, accurately represent, cite and recommend your organisation.

The practical question

When someone asks an AI about our category, does it know who we are, understand what we do, trust the evidence and consider us worth recommending?

READ THIS FIRST

Confidence, not certainty

Much GEO advice turns plausible ideas into claimed ranking factors. This guide separates platform guidance, useful hypotheses and questions that need testing.

CONFIRMED

Platform guidance

Google says AI Overviews and AI Mode use core Search systems and require no special GEO markup. [1]

REASONABLE

Strategic hypothesis

Clear answers, distinct evidence and independent reputation should make a brand easier to represent. Effects vary by platform.

UNPROVEN

Tactic to test

A standalone llms.txt file, artificial content “chunking”, or schema alone will secure citations.

UNKNOWN

Opaque mechanism

The exact weighting of brand signals in a given AI recommendation is not publicly known.

Use the framework as an operating model, not a promise of placement. Measure repeated prompts, record the platform and date, and revisit the evidence.

THE MECHANISM

How an answer gets made

There is no single “AI search algorithm”. Products differ, and the same product can answer from model knowledge, retrieved sources or a combination.

01 **INTERPRET**

The prompt and conversation establish intent.

02 **RETRIEVE**

Some products search live indexes or other sources; Google may fan out to related searches. [2]

03 **SYNTHESISE**

The system composes an answer and may attach links or citations.

04 **RECOMMEND**

A brand can be mentioned, described, cited or shortlisted - different outcomes.

Implication

A webpage edit can change what is retrievable; it does not instantly rewrite model knowledge or guarantee an answer.

THE FRAMEWORK

Five jobs for AI visibility

The Memery AI Visibility Framework follows the path from being available as a source to being confidently recommended.

01

DISCOVER

Can relevant systems access the right information?

02

UNDERSTAND

Is the brand, offer and expertise unambiguous?

03

TRUST

Is the information distinctive, evidenced and corroborated?

04

CITE

Does the brand or its content appear as a source?

05

RECOMMEND

Is the brand shortlisted accurately for relevant needs?

This is a diagnostic sequence, not a claim that every platform follows five discrete stages. Start where the evidence shows a gap.

Make the useful material accessible

A brand cannot be cited from a page a relevant search system cannot discover or read. Begin with established search fundamentals.

- Check indexation and snippet eligibility for priority pages in Google Search Console. [1, 2]
- Review navigation, internal links, canonical pages and XML sitemaps.
- Ensure core copy and evidence are available as readable text, including on mobile.
- Review robots rules and crawler access deliberately; training and search crawlers can have different roles. [3]
- Validate structured data against visible content where it serves a supported purpose. [1]

Practical audit

Pick five high-value service, product or category pages. Can you find each in a search index? Does the rendered page expose its core claims, proof and next step? Is the canonical version the one you intend?

Give the brand a clear identity

Being indexed does not mean a system can confidently connect your organisation with the right category, audience, geography or expertise.

ON YOUR SITE

Entity clarity

Clear About and service pages; consistent names; locations, people, credentials and relationships.

ACROSS THE WEB

Consistency

Aligned profiles, partner pages, directories and expert biographies where your audience looks.

WHAT TO FIX

Ambiguous category language

Write a sentence a customer could repeat: “Memery helps [audience] achieve [outcome] through [services].” Support it with specific pages and proof. Avoid making visitors decode internal jargon.

Try the outsider test

Ask someone unfamiliar with the business to answer: What do we do? For whom? Where? Why believe us? If the site, profiles and media coverage give different answers, you have an entity clarity problem.

Give AI a reason to use you

Generic summaries are easy to reproduce. Publish information that adds something to the public record, then make its origins and limitations clear.

01

Original evidence

Research, benchmarks, first-hand observations, case outcomes and data with methodology.

02

Useful answers

Customer questions, comparisons, constraints and trade-offs addressed in plain language.

03

Named expertise

Real authors, subject experts, credentials, dates and responsible review.

04

Independent support

Relevant media, partners, customers and specialist sources that verify claims.

The editorial test

If AI could have written the piece without your organisation, what makes your organisation the source worth citing?

THE CORROBORATION GAP

What you say / what others say

Your website can make a claim. Independent sources may validate, qualify or contradict it. The distance between those accounts is the corroboration gap.

BRAND CLAIM

“We are the leading choice for complex organisational change.”

EXTERNAL RECORD

What do credible publications, clients, reviews and partners actually associate with you?

AUDIT MOVE

Build an evidence map

Choose five commercial claims. For each, record the owned page, the primary evidence, an independent reference, its date and any inconsistency. Then decide whether to improve the claim, earn validation or correct public information.

- Prioritise credible, relevant sources; a manufactured mention is not an independent endorsement.
- Treat reviews and community discussions as evidence of customer experience, not placements to game.
- Update inaccurate owned content first; then use normal correction routes with third-party publishers.

PROMPT JOURNEYS

Follow the customer conversation

People often move from a broad problem to a specific shortlist. A single prompt snapshot misses where a brand enters, drops out or is misrepresented.

DISCOVER

How do universities improve online student retention?

EXPLORE

Which approaches have measurable evidence?

COMPARE

Which partners could implement this in Australia?

DECIDE

Which option is credible for a university of our size?

Design your prompt set

Cover awareness, problem, evaluation, comparison, reputation, recommendation and risk. Use genuine customer language from calls, search data and research.

A RESEARCH MODULE

Test before claiming to know

The strongest version of this guide includes an original Memery AI Visibility Study. The protocol below makes the work repeatable. No findings are presented here because the study has not yet been run.

SAMPLE**SAMPLE**

Select 30-50 commercially relevant prompts across at least five intent categories; record the selection criteria.

RUN**RUN**

Test on ChatGPT, Gemini, Perplexity and Google AI search experiences, where available. Record geography, date, mode and account state.

REPEAT**REPEAT**

Run each prompt several times and preserve the exact output; one answer is not a stable ranking.

CODE**CODE**

Log brands mentioned, recommendation context, cited domains, claim accuracy and source type. Double-check ambiguous cases.

REPORT**REPORT**

Show denominators, examples, platform differences and uncertainty. Separate descriptive findings from causal claims.

MEASUREMENT

What to measure, and what it means

A citation, a mention and a recommendation are distinct. Use a fixed prompt panel as a directional benchmark, alongside business outcomes.

Prompt coverage

Prompts where the brand appears ÷ relevant prompts tested

Mention share

Brand mentions ÷ all tracked competitor and brand mentions

Citation share

Citations to your domains ÷ citations to tracked category domains

Recommendation rate

Recommendation prompts where the brand is shortlisted ÷ recommendation prompts

Accuracy rate

Correct factual claims about the brand ÷ claims checked

Add business signals

Bing provides AI citation reporting [4]. Combine that with AI referrals, branded search, qualified enquiries and a “How did you hear about us?” question.

AI REPUTATION

When AI gets the brand wrong

Visibility is useful only if the description is accurate. Test factual questions and buying objections, not just category recommendations.

- What does this organisation do, and for whom?
- Where does it operate, and what does it cost?
- Who owns it? Who are its named experts?
- What evidence supports its strongest claims?
- What are the limitations or complaints?
- Would you recommend it for a specific use case? Why?

Response ladder

- 1 Record the exact answer, prompt, platform and date.
- 2 Trace the source of the error, if the product reveals one.
- 3 Correct your own canonical facts and contact third parties where appropriate.
- 4 Retest over time and record what changes.

THE SCORECARD

Score your starting point

Rate each item from 0 to 3. This is a planning aid, not a universal benchmark: 0 = absent; 1 = inconsistent; 2 = established; 3 = strong and evidenced.

Discoverability	Priority pages indexed, readable and connected	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Clarity	Category, offer, people and location consistent	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Answerability	Customer questions and comparisons answered	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Distinctiveness	Original evidence and real-world cases	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Corroboration	Credible outside sources support core claims	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Reputation	AI descriptions checked and mostly accurate	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Visibility	Mentions, citations and recommendations tracked	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

Total / 21

0-7: establish the basics • 8-14: close specific gaps • 15-21: test at scale

A WORKING PLAN

Your first 90 days

Choose a narrow, commercial category first. Establish a baseline before changing the site or launching a campaign.

DAYS 1-30

Understand

Select prompts and competitors. Capture repeated responses. Audit indexation, brand accuracy and cited sources. Define two or three priority gaps.

DAYS 31-60

Improve

Fix core technical and factual issues. Rewrite priority pages around real questions and evidence. Publish a genuinely useful study, case or expert resource.

DAYS 61-90

Expand

Distribute the insight through relevant partners and publications. Retest the same panel. Compare visibility, accuracy and qualified demand.

Give one owner responsibility for the panel and change log. Keep prompts, settings and coding rules stable enough to compare waves.

CONTEXT MATTERS

One framework, different evidence

The priority sources and questions vary by decision type. Use these as starting hypotheses for your own prompt and source audit.

B2B

Technical depth, category comparisons, implementation evidence and customer outcomes.

Consumer

Product facts, availability, reviews, comparisons and lived experience.

Professional services

Named practitioners, credentials, published expertise and case evidence.

Education

Course facts, admissions, outcomes, institutional standing and student experience.

Local

Accurate location details, services, hours, reviews and relevant local references.

What we would not bet on

The point is not to reject experimentation. It is to avoid presenting an unproven tactic as a guaranteed shortcut.

“GEO replaces SEO”

Google states its existing search fundamentals still apply to its AI features. [1]

“Add llms.txt and get cited”

Google says it does not use llms.txt for Search or its generative features. Other products may differ. [1]

“Schema guarantees a citation”

Structured data should match visible content and supported features; it does not buy placement. [1]

“Publish thousands of AI pages”

Scale without new value risks thin, repetitive content and poor user experience. [1, 5]

“One prompt proves success”

Outputs can vary by platform, context and run; treat a single response as an observation.

WORKING TEMPLATE

Build a prompt audit panel

Start with five prompts per intent category. Paste the same wording into your panel, then document deviations and follow-up questions.

Awareness What is [category], and when is it useful?

Problem How can [audience] solve [problem]?

Evaluation What should I look for in [solution]?

Comparison Compare [brand] with [alternatives] for [use case].

Reputation What are the strengths and weaknesses of [brand]?

Recommendation Who would you recommend for [specific need]?

Risk What could go wrong with [brand/approach]?

Record for each run Platform · date · location · prompt · brands · citations · context · errors · reviewer

THE NEXT STEP

Find out what AI thinks about your brand

A useful GEO programme begins with evidence: where the brand appears, what is said, which sources shape the answer and where competitors are selected instead.

The Memery AI Visibility Audit

- A prompt panel built around your customers and competitors
- Visibility, citation, recommendation and accuracy baseline
- Source and corroboration analysis
- Technical and content opportunity map
- A prioritised 90-day action plan

We will show you where your brand appears, where competitors appear instead, and what you can do about it.

Talk to memery about an AI Visibility Audit.

memery.agency

NOTES AND SOURCES

Methods matter

This guide is dated September 2026 and intended as a practical framework. Product behaviour and official guidance can change; verify current documentation before implementation.

[1] Google Search Central

Optimizing your website for generative AI features on Google Search.

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/ai-optimization-guide>

[2] Google Search Central

AI features and your website; query fan-out and eligibility.

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/appearance/ai-features>

[3] OpenAI

Overview of OpenAI crawlers and user agents.

<https://developers.openai.com/api/docs/bots>

[4] Bing Webmaster Tools

AI Performance documentation; platform-specific citation reporting.

<https://www.bing.com/webmasters/help/ai-performance-9f8e7d6c>

[5] Google Search Central

Creating helpful, reliable, people-first content.

<https://developers.google.com/search/docs/fundamentals/creating-helpful-content>